BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
59TH MEDICAL WING

59TH MEDICAL WING INSTRUCTION
41-103

11 DECEMBER 2019

Health Services

AMBULATORY NUTRITION SCREENING

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

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This instruction implements AFPD 41-1, *Health Care Programs and Resources*. This Instruction describes the responsibilities and procedures for screening and assessing the nutritional status of outpatients and ensures that nutrition screening and Medical Nutrition Therapy (MNT) are intrinsic components of clinical practice in the ambulatory setting. This Instruction ensures compliance with the Joint Commission standard. This instruction applies to all personnel assigned, attached, or under contract to the 59th Medical Wing (MDW). This instruction does not apply to those members assigned to the 59 MDW who are working at BAMC. This instruction does not apply to the Air National Guard or Air Force Reserve. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility using the AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*. Ensure that all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained IAW Air Force Manual (AFMAN) 33-363, *Management of Records*, and disposed of IAW Air Force Records Information Management System (AFRIMS) Records Disposition Schedule (RDS).

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

59 MDWI 41-103 has been revised. Changes include added 59 MDW Form 42, *Adult Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment* and 59 MDW Form 43, *Pediatric Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment.*

1. Program Responsibilities. This instruction applies to outpatient clinic personnel throughout the 59 MDW. It provides recommended criteria regarding the nutritional screening of outpatients to evaluate nutrition risk and the need for MNT or nutrition education, as appropriate.

Patients identified to be at nutrition risk and referred to the Outpatient Nutrition Clinic will be assessed and followed by a registered dietitian or certified diet therapy technician.

2. Program Policy. Outpatient primary care clinics will screen their patients for nutrition risk and document findings. As clinically indicated, other outpatient clinics may consider screening patients for nutrition risk. If a patient is screened to be at nutritional risk, the health care provider will determine if a consult to the Nutrition Clinic is warranted. Nutritional Medicine staff will also conduct nutrition screening on outpatients attending multidisciplinary classes in which Nutritional Medicine routinely participates, as appropriate.

3. Program Procedures.

3.1. Outpatient clinic personnel and health care providers will accomplish nutrition screening as appropriate using clinical parameters for medical conditions outlined in AFI 44-102, *Medical Care Management* or parameters for other medical conditions deemed appropriate for this facility in Attachment 2 of this instruction. The attachment lists age- and population-specific criteria for the Pediatric and Obstetrics and Gynecology (OB/GYN) Clinics.

3.2. The following data sources may be used in nutrition screening: findings on physical examination or other medical record entries, nutrition screening tools (i.e., 59 MDW approved overprints), Health Enrollment Assessment Review/Preventive Health Assessment health screening data.

3.3. If the findings from the above data suggest a patient is at nutrition risk, then a consult to the Outpatient Nutrition Clinic for MNT or nutrition education should be considered. A nutrition consultation for MNT or nutrition education will include nutrition assessment, nutrition

3.3. If the findings from the above data suggest a patient is at nutrition risk, then a consult to the Outpatient Nutrition Clinic for MNT or nutrition education should be considered. A nutrition consultation for MNT or nutrition education will include nutrition assessment, nutrition counseling, and a plan for reassessment, if applicable.

3.3.1. Consults to the Nutrition Clinic are sent electronically via the Composite Health Care System.

3.3.2. The consult should list nutritionally relevant diagnoses and the diet instruction ordered. The current control of chronic disease and previous diet instruction should be documented in the medical record entry as factors in deferring a nutrition consult.

3.3.3. Patients seen by 59 MDW Nutrition Clinics will be given an initial nutrition questionnaire 59 MDW Form 42, *Adult Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment* or 59 MDW Form 43, *Pediatric Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment* to complete prior to appointment. This form is used to collect additional information from the patient prior to meeting with the dietitian. The form will be submitted to the dietitian directly or may be uploaded into Health Artifact and Image Management Solution (HAIMS). If not uploaded into HAIMS the form will be destroyed upon completion of the appointment.

4. Clinical Guidelines for Nutrition Screening.

4.1. The guidelines noted on attachment 2 indicate what diagnoses or conditions may warrant a MNT or nutrition education referral, or which may only require nutrition education

handouts provided by the Nutrition Clinic staff. Medical Nutrition Therapy or nutrition education will also be provided whenever deemed necessary by the health care provider and is not limited to the diagnoses listed in the attachment.

4.2. Outpatient Nutrition Clinic personnel will provide education to 59 MDW outpatient clinic personnel on nutrition screening requirements by giving information at the new resident orientation, annual professional staff briefings, or by other effective methods to raise awareness and promote the nutrition screening process.

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Administrator

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

AFPD 41-1, *Health Care Programs and Resources*, 3 October 2018

AFI 41-210, *TRICARE Operations and Patient Administration Functions*, 6 June 2012

AFI 44-102, *Medical Care Management*, 17 March 2015

AFMAN 44-144, *Nutritional Medicine*, 20 January 2016

Prescribed Forms

59 MDW Form 42*, Adult Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment*

59 MDW Form 43, *Pediatric Medical Nutrition Therapy Initial Assessment*

Adopted Form

AF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Acronyms and Abbreviations

HAIMS—Health Artifact and Image Management Solution

MDW—Medical Wing

MNT—Medical Nutrition Therapy

OB/GYN—Obstetrics and Gynecology

Terms

Medical Nutrition Therapy—An assessment of a patient's nutritional status followed by therapy ranging from diet modification and counseling to administration of specialized nutrition products. In military treatment facilities, MNT is available when patients are referred to a credentialed registered dietitian or authorized nutrition care provider.

Nutrition Assessment—A comprehensive approach, completed by a registered dietitian or authorized diet therapy technician, to define nutrition status; uses medical and dietary histories, physical examination, anthropometric measurements, and laboratory data. Includes interpretation of information from the screening process. The assessment process includes a review of data from other disciplines that may affect the assessment process

Nutrition Education—General nutrition information that differs from MNT in that it is population-based risk reduction versus intervention and does not include an in-depth assessment.

Nutrition Screening—The process of identifying characteristics known to be associated with nutrition problems. Its purpose is to pinpoint individuals who are malnourished or at nutrition risk.

Attachment 2

CLINICAL GUIDELINES FOR NUTRITION REFERRAL

AMBULATORY CLINICS

Cancer and/or cancer treatment
Celiac sprue/gluten enteropathy
Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease
Congestive heart failure
Cystic fibrosis
Dependence on nutrition support (enteral or parenteral nutrition)
Diabetes
Disordered eating / unusual dietary or food limiting practices
Dyslipidemia/Coronary artery disease/Cardiovascular disease
Excessive use of dietary supplements
Gastrointestinal disorders interfering with food intake or nutrient absorption
General nutrition education / wellness
HIV/AIDS
Hypertension
Inadequate financial resources for food
Iron deficiency anemia
Liver disease
Malnutrition Failure to thrive/Involuntary weight loss
Obesity
Renal disease
Substance abuse
Vegan or restriction of all foods of animal origin
Any other nutritional concerns that the provider would like assessed by a dietitian

OB/GYN SPECIFIC*	PEDIATRIC SPECIFIC*
Adolescent pregnancy	Failure to thrive
Gestational or overt diabetes	Food allergy / intolerance
High-risk pregnancy	
Hyperemesis gravidarum	
Inadequate or excessive weight gain	
Low pre-pregnancy weight	
Multipara	

***In addition to parameters for 'Ambulatory Clinics'**